

Australia

Australia is the world's smallest continent, but it is a huge country. Most Australians live on the coast, far from the vast, dusty deserts that make up the outback.

Poisonous animals

More poisonous animals live in Australia than in any other country.



The male **platypus** has a poisonous spur on each of its back ankles.



A **box jellyfish's** sting causes terrible pain that lasts for weeks and can kill.



Taipans are the world's deadliest snakes. A bite can kill in 30 minutes.



Sea snake venom can kill a child, but bites from these shy snakes are rare.



Cone shells are sea snails with deadly stings. The venom causes suffocation.



Funnel-web spiders have poisonous fangs. One bite can be fatal.



The tiny **blue-ringed octopus** can paralyse and kill a person with its bite.

